



» FIGHT CLUB

A title on ice, a night out of control

The **Aspinall-Gane bout** was the first UFC title fight to end in a no-contest due to an accidental foul.

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UFC heavyweight champion Tom Aspinall's first title defence against Cyril Gane in October ended prematurely in a no-contest due to an accidental eye poke.

Following the incident, the 32-year-old British fighter announced that he had been diagnosed with Brown's syndrome in both eyes, a rare condition that restricts upward eye movement.

A medical report shared by Aspinall on *Instagram* detailed that he is currently experiencing double vision, reduced eye movement and function, and significant loss of visual field.

The report also noted that if his symptoms do not resolve naturally, he may require targeted steroid injections or surgical intervention.

Aspinall stated that he is currently barred from fighting and MMA training as he follows doctors' orders. He also expressed a strong desire for

a rematch with Gane once he is declared "100% right" and medically fit to return to the cage.

However, the diagnosis presents a significant setback for Aspinall, who only recently captured the UFC heavyweight title.

As a new champion, Aspinall's immediate priority would have been to establish his dominance and legitimacy.

The need for potential treatment, whether through steroid injections or surgery, coupled with subsequent recovery and healing time, means his return could be protracted.

This puts a pause on the trajectory of his reign just as it was beginning, preventing him from defending his belt and potentially pushing the heavyweight division into a period of relative stagnation at the top.

The UFC may even need to consider creating an interim title if his absence is expected to be lengthy.

The Madison Square brawl

Minutes before the main card of UFC 322 in New York last month, chaos

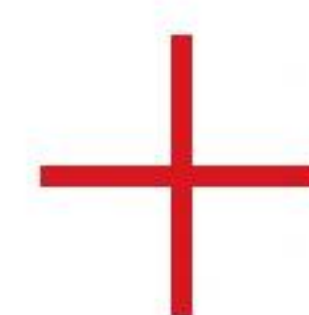
Costly error: Former interim champion Cyril Gane apologised after his eye poke, which appeared to clip both of Aspinall's eyes, though the right eye bore the brunt of the damage. AP

erupted cageside as the bitter, years-long feud between Dillon Danis and the Dagestani camp, led by Islam Makhachev, finally boiled over.

Danis, who was allegedly provoking Makhachev's team with offensive content on his phone, was violently confronted by multiple members of the group, including Dana White Series contender Magomed "Chanco" Zaynukov. The resulting melee saw punches thrown, barricades crash down, and security scrambling to separate those involved.

UFC CEO Dana White, who admitted he miscalculated by allowing Danis near the opposing camp, immediately issued a lifetime ban against Danis from all future UFC events.

However, the controversy did not end there. The violence was deemed "unacceptable" by New York City Mayor Eric Adams, who ordered the NYPD to launch a full criminal investigation, meaning legal consequences may still follow for everyone involved.



Did you know?

Aspinall holds the official UFC record for the shortest average fight time across the entire organisation, with an astonishing average of just two minutes and 18 seconds.

Out of his eight UFC victories, six have ended before the first round is halfway over, showcasing his explosive power and clinical finishing ability, whether by knockout or submission. While other big men might settle for a slow, grinding battle, Aspinall is always looking for the finish, making his fights some of the most anticipated and brief spectacles in the sport.